Fading, by degrees.

Twelve specimens, from a few letters to a flowing story. Each numbered frame is editable.
The settings below were applied by Tracking Ramp itself; the changing text is the demonstration.

01 A widening sentence

Tracking / Word / Linear / 0 to 180
Change: Letters / Auto steps / Entire story

Light had been working quietly. Each morning it crossed the room, touched the same objects, and took a little color with it. Blue softened into grey. A photograph grew pale at its edges, while the face at its center remained almost familiar.

Long text: one continuous ramp across all words.

02 Only the spaces

Tracking / Word / Linear / 0 to 850
Change: Spaces / Auto steps / Entire story

Some things fade

between the words

we leave behind.

The letters stay together; the gaps gradually open.

03 A bell in every line

Tracking / Word / Gaussian / 0 to 260
Restart: Line / Fully justified / Metrics: on

The room keeps a softer record of us. Curtains
0 57 163 260 260 163 57 0
lose their blue. Paper turns warm at the edges.
0 45 126 218 260 218 126 45 0
Every line begins again, opening at its center
0 57 163 260 260 163 57 0
and returning to quiet before the next breath.
0 57 163 260 260 163 57 0

5 pt numbers print in the gap below each text row.

04 Small, large, small

Font size / Character / Gaussian / 14 to 48 pt
Restart: Word / Change: Both / Auto steps

fading
fading
fading

The complete size curve starts again inside each word.

05 A rising memory

Baseline shift / Character / Sine / 0 to 14 pt
Restart: Never / Change: Letters / Auto steps

What stays
when light
leaves?

The glyphs rise and fall. Leading stays at 48 pt.

06 Color, then begin again

Character color / Word / Linear / Ink to Mist
Restart: Paragraph / Change: Both / Auto steps

A letter fades from black to a quiet trace. Its message remains, even as the ink grows light.

The second memory begins in darkness, then follows the first toward the edge of sight.

Each paragraph repeats the same color transition.

07 A sentence stretches

Horizontal scale / Word / Linear / 65 to 145%
Restart: Sentence / Change: Both / Auto steps

The edges grow quiet.

The hours spread thin.

The colors drift away.

Three sentences; three independent distributions.

08 Lean and drift

Skew: -20 to 20 degrees / Character / Linear
Rotation: -12 to 12 degrees / Character / Sine

a leaning *memory*

letters drift away

Two separate targets; generous leading leaves room.

09 Weight and outline

Variable weight: 800 to 100 / Word / Linear
Stroke width: 0 to 1 pt / Character / Linear

Light loses weight.

almost gone

Axis: Weight. The lower sample has a white fill.

10 A shaped measure

Line width: 58 to 100% / Centered / Smooth
Independent Gaussian contour; text tracking: 0

A room can fade without becoming empty. Light still reaches the table. A cup still marks its small circle on the wood. Only the boundaries change: the space narrows, opens, and narrows again, holding a different measure of the same familiar words. We keep reading until the edges close around the last quiet trace of a place we thought would always stay.

A longer passage flows through a changing frame width.

11 What fits the frame

Current frame / Character / Linear / 0 to 100
Same longer text; left: original / right: applied

ORIGINAL

Light leaves slowly. It crosses the room every morning, taking a little color from the curtains and a little certainty from the photograph. The objects remain in place. Their edges become less exact, until memory supplies the details

APPLIED

Light leaves slowly. It crosses the room every morning, taking a little color from the curtains and a little certainty from the photograph. The objects remain in place. Their edges become less exact, until memory

Text leaving the right frame returns to its baseline.

12 One linked story

Tracking / Frame / Linear / 0 to 140
Entire story / Change: Both / Two linked frames

FRAME 1 / 0

Fading is not always a departure. Sometimes it is a change in how a thing remains. The photograph stays on the shelf, the path stays through the grass, and the voice stays somewhere in the room. What disappears is the sharp border

FRAME 2 / 140

between presence and memory. We learn the shape again through its softer edges.

The curve assigns one value to each visible frame.

OPEN & EXPLORE

Open the INDD or IDML. In Layers, select a numbered frame on the Editable specimens layer. Run Tracking Ramp.jsx.

REAPPLY A CURVE

Keep Replace previous effect on to start from the saved baseline. Example 03 may use managed soft breaks to preserve exact line curves.

READ THE RESULTS

Auto steps samples every eligible unit. Frame/line groups exclude overset. Examples 11 and 12 intentionally contain longer stories.

A line can change.

Weight and offset follow characters or words. Indents move complete paragraphs.
Each example keeps its saved baseline, so you can replace the curve and explore.

13 Underline weight

Character or Word / Auto steps / 0.2 to 6 pt / Change: Letters
The text stays the same size while the underline grows or forms a bell.

CHARACTER / LINEAR

the ink grows quiet

WORD / GAUSSIAN

one line holds a memory

Underlining switches on automatically. Existing underline color, style and offset are retained.

14 Underline offset

Character: Sine / Word: Linear / -2 to 12 pt / Underline weight held at 1 pt
Negative offsets move above the baseline; positive offsets move below it.

CHARACTER / SINE

the line drifts below the letters

WORD / LINEAR

the words hold another horizon

15 Paragraph indents

Paragraph / Linear / Four steps per sample / One value for each complete paragraph
Left and right: 0 to 72 pt. First line: -18 to 36 pt, with a fixed 18 pt left indent.

LEFT INDENT / 0 TO 72 PT

Light reaches the table. A little color leaves the room.

Memory keeps the edges. A familiar shape becomes less exact.

The page grows quieter. We read what remains between words.

Nothing leaves at once. The last trace takes its time.

RIGHT INDENT / 0 TO 72 PT

Light reaches the table. A little color leaves the room.

Memory keeps the edges. A familiar shape becomes less exact.

The page grows quieter. We read what remains between words.

Nothing leaves at once. The last trace takes its time.

FIRST LINE / -18 TO 36 PT

Light reaches the table. A little color leaves the room.

Memory keeps the edges. A familiar shape becomes less exact.

The page grows quieter. We read what remains between words.

Nothing leaves at once. The last trace takes its time.

WHOLE PARAGRAPHS

A partial selection includes each paragraph it touches. Indents can also affect a continuation in another frame or overset.

REPLACE & RESTORE

Cancel restores the starting formatting. Reapplying restores old targets before assigning new values. Underline automatic values are preserved.

ONE CURVE PER SCOPE

Indent properties use Paragraph, Both and Never restart. Curves run across the selected paragraphs without splitting their formatting.